



Cover story TELEVISION



INDIA'S GOT TALENT

COLORS

Has an inspired judges' panel, among them a teary eyed Shekhar Kapur, and performers who range from limbless dancers to women who can sing like men. Began on June 27, it has an average TRP of 2.5.

SMS 'greenovation1' to 57007* now and take the pledge to recycle responsibly.

To be a Greenovator OR not, is the question. The choice is in your hands.

Khiladi, *Bigg Boss 2* and *Balika Vadhu* on prime time and shook the viewers and channels. Till then most reality based contests, except for *Bigg Boss 1* on Sony, were kept for weekends but Colors made them weekday programming. Wonder boy CEO Rajesh Kamat's formula of "disruptive programming" worked. The channel chose to follow the attention grabbing policy with its fiction shows too. *Balika Vadhu* succeeded because people were curious about child marriage and *Na Aana is Des Laado* got numbers because of its controversial female infanticide theme.

Other channels followed. Zee TV scrapped its entire prime time programming and stuck its neck out with social themes of selling the girl child in *Agle Janam Mohe Bitiya hi Kijo* and autism in *Aapki Antara*. The channel is now in the process of doing away with its two oldest shows, *Ghar Ki Lakshmi Betiyaan* and *Maayka*. Sony, which had been languishing at No. 3 before Colors, got pushed to four and then five because of NDTV Imagine. The channel shook things up with an entire line up of new shows such as *Bhaskar Bharti*, *Ladies Special* and *Palampur Express* but the move didn't work with the shows averaging TRPs between 0.5 and 1. Executives at

*Special rates apply.